Lenovo's Superfish security snafu blows up in its face

The preloaded Superfish adware does more than hijack website ads in a browser. It also exposes Lenovo owners to a simple but dangerous hack that could spell disaster.

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Security

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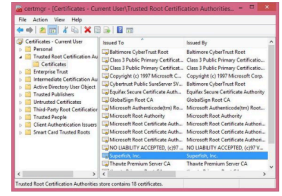


by Seth Rosenblatt
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Removing software that comes with your brand-new Windows computer can be frustrating, but recently discovered software on new Lenovo laptops -- the **top-selling laptop brand** in 2014 -- can put your entire digital life at risk.

The preloaded software, called Superfish, alters your search results to show you different ads than you would otherwise see. But it also tampers with your computer's security so that attackers can snoop on your browser traffic -- no matter which browser you're using.

"Attackers are able to see all the communication



Superfish code hides in hard-to-reach places on your new Lenovo laptop, making it difficult to remove.

Screenshot by Robert Graham/Errata Security

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